

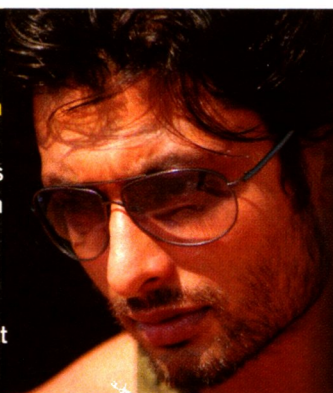


Dream Works

Here's an aspiring Indian-American filmmaker who has caught Steven Spielberg's eye. Shalini Kantayya from Brooklyn, New York, is now on television screens worldwide, thanks to Spielberg's reality show *On The Lot*, his search for a talented filmmaker who will win the "chance of a lifetime". Selected out of 12,000 entries, Kantayya, 30, who describes herself as a "tech-head, a tree-hugger, a humanist", is now among the final 15. With a \$1-million development deal at DreamWorks at stake, here's hoping this activist filmmaker makes the cut.

Salsa in Mumbai

Model-turned-television-actor **Indraneil Sengupta** has now jumped from the small screen to 70 mm. The 32-year-old hunk from Ahmedabad has been signed on to play one of the leads in Vikram Bhatt's upcoming film *Mumbai Salsa*. "Director Manoj Tyagi was an acquaintance and he asked me to audition for the film," says the actor, who will be playing the role of a womanising merchant banker. Here's wishing him a 'profitable' future.



Family Ties

She sizzled in the "Chunari Chunari" number in Mira Nair's *Monsoon Wedding*. Although theatre actor Neha Dubey, 26, has taken a break from Bollywood to pursue her masters in psychology in London, she will be back for mother Lillete Dubey's directorial venture. "Working with Neha is fun. But I think mothers are more demanding with children," says Lillete. Soon to be seen in Pritish Nandi Communications' *Bow Barracks Forever*, the duo lists other mother-daughter combinations they admire:

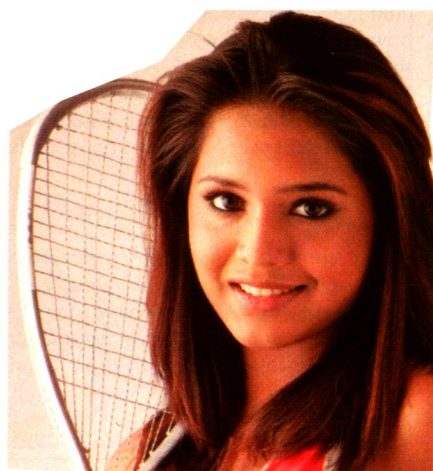
APARNA SEN AND KONKONA: They are a rare combination and have done some great work together.

HEMA MALINI, ESHA AND AHANA: The three actively work together. Hema has often said that they love performing together.

ZOHRA SEHGAL AND KIRAN: Kiran is an acclaimed Odissi dancer and not many know that Zohra was a dancer too.



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SPORTY SPICE

Dipika Pallikal, 15, has broken into the top 100 of the Women's International Squash Players Association ranking. Ranked 80, Pallikal is being trained in Egypt and hopes to make a mark at the Los Angeles Open this month. Now we hear the Chennai girl is being wooed by filmmakers down south. "I'm concentrating on squash now. But films might happen five years down the line," says the Under-15 Asian Champion and Under 19 National Champion. Good looks and great swings make a killer combo, eh?

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■ Compiled by **Kimi Dangor**



Ab har ghar mein Sachin!

ON YOUR MARK,

FIT KIT, GO!

